

TEN IDEAS

A quick read, about five minutes

Ten possible episodes for a true-crime podcast game. Each one is a title and a single sentence.

What we need from you: a score out of ten, and one line of gut reaction. Anything at all: *boring, confusing, want more, seen it before, don't believe it*. One or two words is plenty.

Gut reaction is the useful thing, not the considered one. Don't be careful, and don't try to be fair to them.

If a sentence does not make sense on one read, say so and score it low. That is a real result, not a failure on your part.

1 • The Intruder Had a Key A husband kills an intruder and is praised for saving his family, but the dead man carried a house key and had been sending money to the wife.

2 • In Her Handwriting Her brother had begged her for months to help him die, and when he finally fell from the lighthouse, the note in his pocket was in her handwriting, but not her words.

3 • The Son Who Came Home A woman was murdered and her son flew home the next morning from another country, and his ticket was bought three days before she died.

4 • The Reunion Had Seven Guests Six friends find a murdered stranger at their reunion, but a photograph taken at their last reunion shows him seated among them.

5 • The Woman in the Photograph Her husband reported her missing on a Tuesday and by Friday he had chosen the photograph the papers would use, and it is not one she would ever have picked.

6 • The Man Who Confessed Twice A dockworker confessed to a murder he could not describe, then died in custody, while the victim's brother quietly took over his home and family.

7 • Five Keys After Midnight Five friends receive keys after a woman's murder, each opening the cupboard where she hid proof that one of them planned her death.

8 • Flowers at the Wrong Grave A man walked into the sea a week after his acquittal, and his mother, who had sworn to his alibi in court, now lays flowers at the victim's grave instead of her son's.

9 • Four Cars Left the Wedding Four bridesmaids swear a murdered bride drove away with her husband, but he had been dead for three hours when they watched the car leave.

10 • The Man Who Waited He sat with her family every day of the trial, brought them food, and cried when the verdict came in; he had killed her in March.

Two questions at the end, if you have another minute:

Which one would you listen to first?

Was there one you would not listen to at all?